

WEBAMON-TIR-2026-07 · 2026-07-30 · Senior Threat Intelligence Analyst

THE GAMBLING MACHINE

An industry threat overview of the illicit online gambling / iGaming ecosystem, drawn from Webamon passive web-scan intelligence

Illicit online gambling is the single largest category of coordinated malicious web infrastructure in the Webamon estate — not a scatter of scam sites, but an industrialised, kit-driven supply chain with distinct functional layers, each mass-produced across thousands of disposable domains and unified by a handful of trackable fingerprints.

34_{/75}

tracked campaigns are gambling ops — **45%** of all tracked activity

136_k

unique gambling domains — ~35% of the 388K malicious estate

~98%

median fleet liveness — takedown has been engineered out

64.8_k

World-Cup-themed domains minted in Jun–Jul 2026 alone

01 KEY JUDGEMENTS

HIGH

The ecosystem is predominantly **Chinese-language illegal gambling** (Mark Six/六合彩, K8/开云, Yabo/亚博, Sands/金沙 Macau) run as affiliate/agent networks, complemented by **regional white-label franchises** in Brazil (Fortune Tiger "tigrinho", 122bet), Indonesia (BADAK178, 73KSLOT) and Vietnam (388bet, 1gom).

HIGH

Operators have **fully solved domain takedown as a business problem**. Domains are disposable inventory fronted by Cloudflare, backed by dedicated "permanent address release" and "line-selector" mirror layers that re-home users. Median liveness ~98% — live, maintained fleets, not residue.

HIGH

The **2026 FIFA World Cup is a measurable demand shock**: ~64,800 unique World-Cup-themed gambling domains in two months, with registration bursts synchronised to the match calendar.

HIGH

A few **shared fingerprints unify dozens of nominally-separate campaigns** — most of all the **"Keymatic Secure Domain RSA CA G1" certificate authority (~162K unique domains)** and a small set of Tencent/carrier origin IPs — collapsing the ecosystem to a handful of high-value pivots.

Gambling infrastructure is a **crossover malware vector**: a SocGhlish-style "Fake Chrome Update" cluster reuses gambling traffic to push loaders — this is a malware-delivery surface, not only a fraud/regulatory problem.

02 THE ASSEMBLY LINE — FIVE FUNCTIONAL LAYERS

The defining insight: these are not "gambling websites," they are assembly lines. One operator runs multiple domain fleets, each doing one job. Attribution and disruption both start here.

1

Traffic Acquisition — SEO doorways & programmatic spam

Machine-titled doorway pages engineered to rank in search and funnel organic traffic inward (com.cn 007/001 family; Indonesian BADAk178; Vietnamese 388bet).

~11.6K
domains

2

Lure / Doorway — event & brand themed

Themed landing pages that convert a click into "sign up now" (2026 World Cup brand-grid + line-selector templates; 0149 Mark Six nav portal with live draw numbers).

~22K
domains

3

Mirror-Resilience — takedown survival

Fleets whose only job is re-homing users. "永久地址发布页" pages force Ctrl+D bookmarking; line-selectors offer routes around blocked mirrors (66ok.club; k8 mktland).

~11K
domains

4

Registration / Monetisation — the cash register

Bare titleless redirector shells whose only payload is an affiliate /app/register.php URL carrying site_id/topId commission tracking (Metaverse network — the largest single campaign).

~32K
domains

5

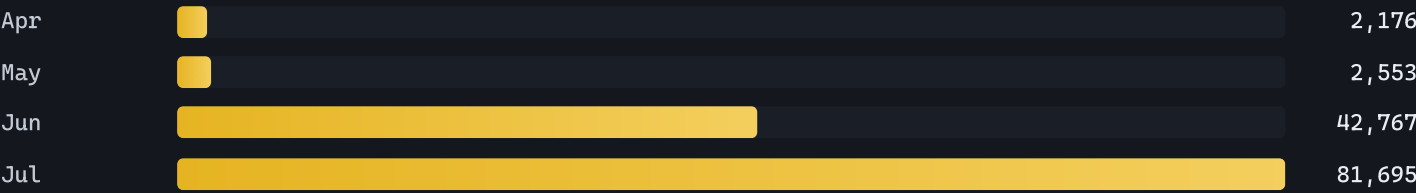
Platform / Brand — the destination

The betting product and its brand-abuse fleets: K8 password-gate portals, Macau Sands/Galaxy impersonation, Brazilian Fortune Tiger white-labels (001win ≈ real 1win).

~18K
domains

Registration waves — new domains per month

June–July 2026 account for 91% of all sector domain creation. Bursts of 5K+/day are deployment events, not organic growth.



Keymatic CA — new domains issued per week

A flat 20K–31K domains/week for two months: the signature of an automated domain+certificate factory. The master pivot.



World Cup seasonality — daily unique domains (世界杯)

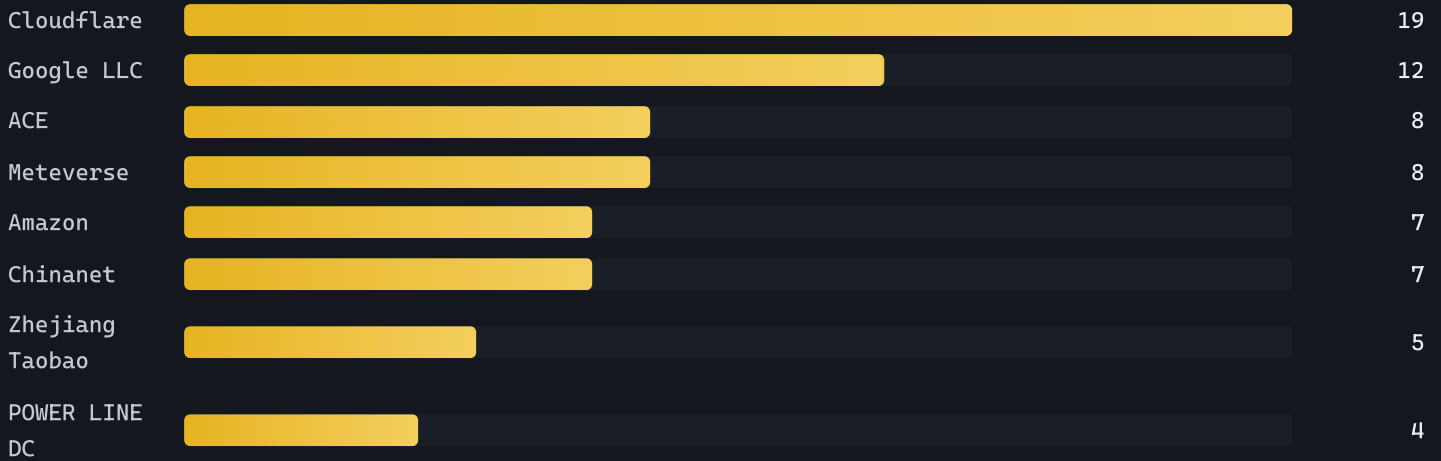
Surge days track the tournament calendar: peak 2026-06-19 (~7,128 unique). Spikes cluster around match dates, then partially decay.



● daily unique 世界杯 domains, Jun 1 – Jul 30 2026

Hosting concentration — origin ASN reuse

Cloudflare fronts most; the **origin** is where attribution lives. Metaverse & ACE behave as dedicated gambling-crime hosts.



TLD economics tell the story. The sector leans on the cheapest bulk-registerable gTLDs — `.top` (61.7K) · `.cc` (47.8K) · `.asia` (26.8K) · `.vip` (16.8K) · `.lol` — precisely because the model treats domains as consumables. Origin centre of gravity (stripping CDN edge): **China** → **Singapore / Hong Kong**.

04 BEHAVIOUR PATTERNS WORTH NOTICING

The non-obvious TTPs that separate sophisticated operators from generic scam spam.

Client-side date-DGA (301ns network)

An inline script computes a YYYYMMDD stamp and rewrites `location` to `{date}.{domain}` — minting a fresh subdomain every day with zero server-side coordination. Defeats subdomain blocklisting; invisible without JS execution.

Bookmark-persistence as infrastructure

The "permanent address release" fleets weaponise the browser — forcing `Ctrl+D` so the victim carries the re-homing link forward. The address-release page, not the casino, is the durable asset.

Conditional / cloaked redirects

Redirects fire via `window.location.href` only for visitors matching operator conditions — scanners see an empty shell. Passive DOM+script capture is one of the few ways to see through it.

Titleless monetisation shells

~28,600 domains with no `<title>` and no content — just an affiliate redirect. Usually dismissed as parked; here they are the most valuable layer. **Do not filter blank titles when hunting gambling infra.**

Regional white-label franchising

One structural kit, re-skinned per market: Fortune Tiger (BR), BADA178 (ID), 388bet (VN). The Brazilian fleet even ships a leftover Turkish cookie banner — evidence of a reusable multi-market kit rented to affiliates.

Extreme title homogeneity

8,135 mirror domains share **2 titles**; 4,300 Mark Six domains share **21**. When thousands of domains render one of a handful of exact titles, you are looking at one operator and one kit.

05 WEBAMON FINGERPRINTS — TRACKING REPEATED CAMPAIGNS

The core deliverable. Content-hash fingerprints survive the domain churn that defeats blocklists. Four master pivots give ecosystem-wide coverage; per-campaign seeds track each operator.

Master pivots — copy-paste into the scans index

Deploy these four as standing monitors for whole-ecosystem visibility.

```
# Highest-value indicator: automated domain+cert factory (~162K domains)
```

```
certificate.issuer:"Keymatic Secure Domain RSA CA G1"
```

```
# Access-gate splash across CN gambling / grey-market fleets
```

```
page_title:"请输入密码访问"
```

```
# Mirror-resilience "permanent address release" layer
```

```
page_title:"永久地址发布页"
```

```
# World Cup demand-shock tracker
```

```
page_title:*世界杯*
```

CAMPAIGN	LAYER	DOMAINS	FINGERPRINT SEED
Meteverse Affiliate Register	monetise	30,792	fingerprint.ssl:600b41fb76d8f540...
2026 World Cup Doorway	lure	16,061	fingerprint.dom:2f4e81089bbdb249...
66ok Mirror-Address	resilience	8,135	fingerprint.dom:ada1d5066cce8a5a...
Gambling ASN+SSL Pair (.vip/.cc)	infra	6,539	fingerprint.asn:c9d04aef... + ssl:622e0636...
0149 Mark Six Nav Portal	lure	5,943	fingerprint.links:e5edb35a838de161...
301ns Date-DGA Redirect	TDS	4,812	fingerprint.scripts:87f708f572196da1...
Indonesian Slot/Togel (BADAk178)	SEO	4,716	fingerprint.tech:f60bb240fb3e9f58...
0007bet Cert Farm	platform	4,540	fingerprint.ssl:7d6a1877beee7cc2...
Brazilian Fortune Tiger	platform	3,500	fingerprint.ssl:8ee1ac6458cb6e53...
Macau Sands/Galaxy Redirect	platform	2,720	fingerprint.links:5ad38ce9f4f6b33a...
k8 Line-Selector (mktland)	resilience	2,415	fingerprint.scripts:73235378c8157864...

Origin IOCs (high-signal): ASNs **Meteverse Limited**, ACE · Tencent origin **43.159.107.113** (8 CN campaigns) · shared Google fronting **142.250.151.94/95** across 8 regional franchises.

06 RECOMMENDATIONS

DETECTION ENG / SOC

1. Deploy the **four master pivots** as standing monitors — ecosystem coverage from four queries.

2. Alert on origin **ASN = Meteverse / ACE**; treat Keymatic certs on cheap gTLDs as high-risk by default.

3. **Do not filter blank-titled domains** — the largest monetisation layer is titleless.

4. Hunt cloaked redirectors on captured **DOM+script fingerprints**, not rendered content.

MONITORING STRATEGY

1. Promote emerging **.asia** football-lottery & **.lol** bracket clusters to tracked campaigns.

2. Add all four **"请输入密码访问" fingerprint-type variants** (links/tech/ssl/dom) as separate monitors.

3. **Pre-position for event surges** — stand up event-themed monitors ahead of major sporting events; expect 20–30K new domains/week.

TAKEDOWN / DISRUPTION

1. Domain-by-domain is defeated by design (~98% liveness + re-homing layer).
2. Prioritise **CA-level and origin-host disruption** (Keymatic issuance; Metaverse/ACE hosting) — the only chokepoints that scale against the factory.
3. Treat gambling traffic as a **malware-delivery surface** — coordinate with anti-malware, not only fraud/AML.

Webamon Threat Intelligence · **TIR-2026-07** · Illicit Online Gambling / iGaming

Source: Webamon scans index + OpenSearch estate · 388,172 domains · 75 campaigns · TLP:AMBER